KOVISE FOUNDATION CONFLICT RESOLUTION INTERNATIONAL

ORGANIZATIONAL STRUCTURE

(FOR WEBSITE USE)

ADVISORY BOARD

1. **Hon'ble Mr. Justice Deepak Verma**

Hon'ble Mr. Justice Deepak Verma is a former Judge of the Supreme Court of India with over four decades of distinguished service in law and judiciary. Since his retirement in 2012, he has acted as an independent mediator and arbitrator in more than 100 domestic and international proceedings under leading institutional and ad hoc rules, advising global corporations and law firms on complex issues of Indian and international commercial law. His expertise spans aviation, energy, infrastructure, insurance, and joint ventures. Earlier, he practiced at the Madhya Pradesh High Court before serving as Judge of the High Courts of Madhya Pradesh and Karnataka, Chief Justice of Rajasthan High Court, and later as Judge of the Supreme Court. He has also contributed to academia as co-author of *Mulla's Civil Procedure Code* and serves on governing councils of several universities. Justice Verma continues to play an active role in committees and associations, combining judicial wisdom with leadership in arbitration and dispute resolution.

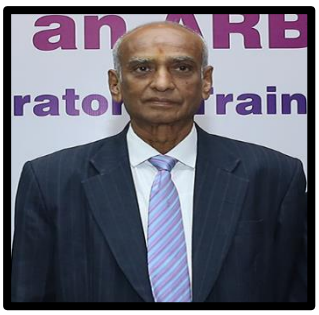
2. HON'BLE MR. JUSTICE K GOVINDARAJAN

Hon'ble Mr. Justice K. Govindarajan retired from the High Court of Madras in 2005 after a distinguished judicial career and now practices as an international arbitrator and adjudicator. With expertise spanning commercial, corporate, intellectual property, maritime, construction, and finance disputes, he has served as Sole and Presiding Arbitrator in numerous international proceedings. He is empaneled with leading institutions including WIPO (Switzerland) and BANI (Indonesia). A graduate in Commerce and Law from the University of Madras, he began his career in 1969 under the mentorship of Thiru K. Venkataswami (later Judge of the Supreme Court of India), before establishing his own practice and eventually being elevated to the High Court bench. He currently also serves as Chairman of the State Level Commission for Backward Classes, Pondicherry, continuing his commitment to justice and public service.

3. HON'BLE JUSTICE DR. P JYOTHIMANI

Hon'ble Justice Dr. P. Jyothimani served as a Judge of the Madras High Court after nearly three decades of distinguished practice in civil and appellate matters. A Ph.D. in Criminology from the University of Madras, he advised leading institutions including the University of Madras and Food Corporation of India, and represented prominent trusts and associations in significant cases, particularly in the field of education. Elevated to the High Court bench in 2005, he later served as Judicial Member of the National Green Tribunal from 2012, contributing to landmark decisions in environmental jurisprudence. His career reflects a blend of academic depth, practical expertise, and judicial leadership.

4. HON'BLE JUSTICE MR. E PADMANABHAN



Hon'ble Justice E. Padmanabhan retired as Judge of the Madras High Court in 2003 after a distinguished career marked by landmark judgments in constitutional, administrative, company, and environmental law. Designated Senior Advocate in 1994, he specialized in writs, service matters, and administrative law before his elevation to the bench in 1996. As Judge, he presided over significant cases including corruption trials, women's workplace rights, transport regulation, and legislative powers, and contributed extensively to company and electricity law jurisprudence. He also served on the Green Bench, advancing environmental protection, and held roles such as President of the State Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission and Executive Chairman of the Legal Services Authority in Pondicherry. Post-retirement, he has been active as an arbitrator and presiding arbitrator in domestic and international disputes, empanelled with institutions including the Indian Council of Arbitration and MCX, and appointed in high-profile matters by the Supreme Court and major corporations. His contributions extend to legal education, consumer protection, and energy law, reflecting a career dedicated to justice, reform, and dispute resolution.

5. **Mr. SUJEET KUMAR**

Sujeet Kumar is a lawyer, social entrepreneur, and Founder of *LexMantra*, a full-service legal consulting firm advising corporations, multilateral agencies, investors, and individuals on legal, regulatory, and governance matters. He also co-founded *Kalinga Kusum*, a social enterprise focused on education and legal empowerment in rural communities. With over two decades of experience across corporate, government, legal, and non-profit sectors, he has held senior policy positions including Advisor to the Special Development Council of Odisha and Special Secretary of the Odisha State Planning Board, and has served as a Global Leadership Fellow at the *World Economic Forum*. He is currently a Member of Parliament in the Rajya Sabha representing Odisha, where he continues to advocate for bridging law, development, and social entrepreneurship. An alumnus of *Harvard Kennedy School* (MPA), *Oxford University's Said Business School* (MBA), and Sambalpur University (LL.B.), Sujeet is also a trained arbitrator handling matters related to start-ups, technology, and IPR disputes, while mentoring entrepreneurs, social enterprises, and impact-driven organizations in India and abroad.

6. Mr. ARRAN DOWLING – HUSSEY

Prof. Arran Dowling-Hussey is a Barrister, Arbitrator, Adjudicator, and Accredited Mediator practicing at *4–5 Gray's Inn Square, London* and in Dublin. He has acted as counsel and neutral in over 100 ADR hearings across commercial, construction, consumer, landlord–tenant, and sports law disputes. A Fellow of the Chartered Institute of Arbitrators, he has served as CIArb Trustee (2017–2024) and previously on its Board of Management. He is Co-editor of the *Construction, Engineering & Energy Law Journal of Ireland* and co-author of three editions of the leading Irish textbook *Arbitration Law*, widely cited in Irish superior court judgments. Arran has lectured extensively in arbitration and dispute resolution in Ireland, the UK, Pakistan, the UAE, and Armenia, with over 1,000 hours of teaching at third level since 2004. He is a member of the Council of the Society of Construction Law UK and the European Society of Construction Law, and has contributed to numerous professional committees including the Bar Council of Ireland ADR Committee and the Adjudication Society in Ireland. He is currently pursuing a part-time PhD in international arbitration at the *University of Groningen* and continues to combine practice, scholarship, and teaching in advancing ADR globally.

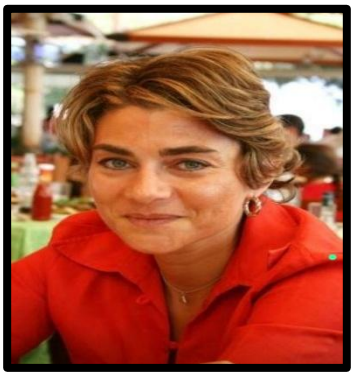
7. **Dr. CHRISTOPHER TO**

Dr. Christopher To is an Arbitrator, Adjudicator, Mediator, and Dispute Resolution Specialist based in Hong Kong, with extensive experience across international disputes spanning investment, construction, aviation, and technology. He is a recognized leader in ADR, serving on panels of major institutions including the *AALCO Hong Kong Regional Arbitration Centre*, *Weihai Arbitration Commission*, *Russian Arbitration Center*, *Vietnam International Arbitration Centre*, *Thailand Arbitration Center (THAC)*, and *Maldives International Arbitration Centre*. He has also held leadership roles such as Immediate Past Chairman of the *Hong Kong Institution of Engineers' Construction Dispute Resolution Committee* and Immediate Past Chairman of the *Hong Kong Institute of Directors*. A strong advocate of corporate governance, he has served as Non-Official Director of the *Financial Dispute Resolution Centre* and contributed to numerous professional committees worldwide. Dr. To holds a Ph.D. in Mediation from the *University of Stirling* and a Master's in Arbitration and Dispute Resolution from *City University of Hong Kong*. Named among the **Top 10 Mediators in Asia-Pacific (2019–2020)**, he continues to combine practice, teaching, and thought leadership to advance dispute resolution globally.

8. Mr. FRANCIS XAVIER S.C., PBM

Francis Xavier is a Senior Counsel (appointed in 2009) and Regional Head of Disputes Practice, specializing in international arbitration, treaty arbitration, and complex commercial litigation. He has acted in high-profile cross-border disputes in banking, finance, property, and energy, including the first case heard before the Singapore International Commercial Court. Recognized as a leading lawyer by *AsiaLaw Profiles*, *Legal 500*, *Chambers Global*, *Who's Who Legal*, and *Benchmark Litigation Asia-Pacific*, he has also advised on landmark aviation cases such as the SilkAir and SIA crash litigations. Francis sits as a party-nominated arbitrator in ICSID treaty disputes, assists Asian governments in developing arbitration frameworks, and serves in leadership roles as Chartered Arbitrator, immediate Past Chairman of CIArb Singapore, President-Elect of the Inter-Pacific Bar Association, and Vice President of CIArb (UK). His career reflects deep expertise in dispute resolution and international arbitration leadership.

9. Dr. NATHALIE NAJJAR



Dr. Nathalie Najjar is a Professor of Law at *Saint Joseph University, Beirut*, an Attorney at Law registered with the Beirut Bar, and an Arbitrator with extensive experience in both domestic and international disputes. She holds a Ph.D. in Law summa cum laude from *University of Paris II – Panthéon Assas*, where she also lectured for nearly a decade on arbitration in the Arab countries. At USJ, she teaches courses on domestic and international arbitration in advanced law programs and has supervised numerous doctoral theses. As Senior Partner at *Ibrahim Najjar Law Firm*, she has acted as counsel and arbitrator in complex cases, including representing the Lebanese State before ICSID. She is the author of several acclaimed works on arbitration and international trade in the Arab world, including *Arbitration and International Trade in the Arab Countries* (Brill-Nijhoff, 2018), and has contributed widely to scholarly articles and conferences. Dr. Najjar also serves as President of the Arbitration Commission of *ICC Lebanon* and as General Secretary of the *Lebanese Review of Arab and International Arbitration*, continuing to shape both academic and professional discourse in the field of dispute resolution.

10. Prof. Dr. KAJ HOBER

Prof. Kaj Hober is a Swedish lawyer, arbitrator, and academic with over four decades of experience in international arbitration, investment disputes, and East-West trade. A Doctor of Laws from Uppsala University, he has served as Commissioner at the UN Compensation Commission in Geneva, arbitrator at the Court of Arbitration for Sport, and professor of international law at universities in Sweden and the UK. He has acted as counsel and arbitrator in more than 200 international arbitrations across Europe, the US, Asia, and Africa, with particular expertise in energy, construction, and investment disputes. His career includes advising governments on privatization in Eastern Europe, representing major corporations in oil and gas arbitrations, and contributing to landmark investment treaty cases under ICSID and the Energy Charter Treaty. A former managing partner in Moscow for Mannheimer Swartling, he combines academic authority with extensive practical experience in complex cross-border disputes.

11. Prof. Dr. LOUKAS MISTELIS

Professor Loukas Mistelis is a leading authority on international dispute resolution and investment treaty law. He is the Clive M. Schmitthoff Professor of Transnational Commercial Law and Arbitration and Director of the School of International Arbitration at Queen Mary University of London. Recognized globally as one of the "45 under 45" leading lights in arbitration and listed as a *Who's Who Legal* Thought Leader, he also serves on the ICSID Panel of Arbitrators. His extensive arbitration practice spans ICC, ICSID, LCIA, UNCITRAL, SCC, and other institutions, covering disputes in energy, construction, aviation, trade, and investment across multiple jurisdictions. Professor Mistelis has held visiting appointments at NYU, Pepperdine, NUS, Keio University, and others, and has advised governments, UN agencies, and international organizations on law reform and arbitration frameworks. His scholarship and leadership have shaped the global discourse on arbitration, harmonization of procedures, and protection of foreign investment.

FOUNDING COMMITTEE

1. Mr. V INBAVIJAYAN (FCIArb (UK), PAP-KFCRI) – Global Advisor, KFCRI

V. Inbavijayan is an International Arbitrator, Mediator, and ADR Specialist with nearly three decades of practice, having acted in over 450 domestic and 19 international arbitrations across sectors including trade, maritime, construction, finance, IPR, and investment disputes. A Fellow of multiple arbitral institutions worldwide, he is Managing Partner of *KoVe Global LLP*, Registered Foreign Lawyer with the *Singapore International Commercial Court*, the UK Solicitors Regulatory Authority, and the *Astana International Financial Centre, Kazakhstan*. He serves as Regional Pathway Leader, Course Director, and Tutor at *CIArb UK*, Co-Chairperson of the *CIArb South India Chapter*, and Governing Council Member of the *Indian Council of Arbitration*. Inbavijayan is also the Global Advisor and Managing Committee Member of Kovise Foundation Conflict Resolution International (KFCRI), Founder of the *Global South ADR Alliance*, and has held leadership roles with SICCI and AIADR. Recognized internationally for his expertise, he has contributed extensively to scholarship, lectured at leading law schools, and represented India in global ADR forums, continuing to advance arbitration practice and institutional growth worldwide.

2. Ms. SURYA NARMADA INBAVIJAYAN – FOUNDER, KFCRI

Surya Narmada Inbavijayan is the Founder of Kovise Foundation Conflict Resolution International (KFCRI), a pioneering institution dedicated to advancing alternative dispute resolution (ADR) globally. She is also a horticulturist, agriculture arbitration consultant, and government-registered valuer for agricultural lands. With a postgraduate degree in horticulture from Tamil Nadu Agricultural University, she has over two decades of experience as a consultant, trainer, and advisor in agriculture and horticulture. Surya is the Proprietor of *Kovise Agro*, an agribusiness venture that connects farmers and producer companies directly with consumers, and the Founder and Managing Trustee of *Kovise Foundation*, which promotes knowledge, vision, and social empowerment in rural communities. Additionally, she is a Partner at *KoVe Global LLP*, an arbitration and ADR boutique, where she specializes in agriculture and commodity arbitration. Her expertise spans farm planning, orchard management, landscape design, and therapeutic horticulture, and she has conducted extensive training programs for NGOs, universities, and rural communities. A Fellow of the Institution of Valuers, she continues to advance innovative approaches to agriculture, dispute resolution, and sustainable development.

3. **Mr. Pranav I – Co-Founder KFCRI**

Pranav I is a civil engineering graduate and law student specializing in construction law and international arbitration. He is the Co-Founder and Intern Coordinator at KFCRI ADR Institution and a Charter Member of the GSADR Alliance. Pranav has gained practical experience through internships with leading legal practitioners, chambers, and institutions, including the Chambers of Mr. V. Inbavijayan, BDN Chambers, and the High Court of Madras. He has also worked with Larsen & Toubro in their Contracts Division and coordinated projects at Kovise Foundation. His academic journey includes a Bachelor of Engineering from SRM University, ongoing LLB (Hons) studies at Tamil Nadu Dr. Ambedkar Law University, and executive education in international commercial arbitration at King's College London. With certifications in construction law, investment arbitration, and dispute resolution, Pranav combines technical expertise with legal training, aspiring to build a career in international arbitration practice.

4. **Mr. SUVETHAN G S – Co-Founder, KFCRI**

Suvethan G.S. is an Arbitration and Mediation practitioner who has taken on roles as Tribunal Secretary, Mediator, Counsel, and Arbitrator. Beginning his practice while still a law student at the School of Excellence in Law, Tamil Nadu Dr. Ambedkar Law University, he has since contributed to the development of several ADR institutions including KFCRI, SICCI Centre for ADR, IITArb, and CIArb, assisting with rule-making, training, and client engagement. His academic excellence is reflected in national and international moot court achievements and published research on ADR in sector-specific contexts such as Construction and Intellectual Property. Accredited with institutions including AIADR, CIArb, AAA, ICDR, and ACICA, he is also empaneled as an International Mediator with ADR ODR International, UK. Suvethan is the founder of *JUS MOMENTUM*, a training initiative promoting amicable dispute resolution methods, and is recognized for his commitment, attention to detail, and leadership in advancing ADR practice.

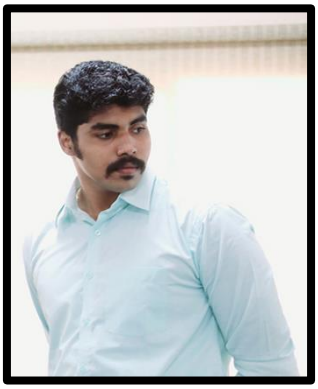
5. **Ms. SRI NIKILA M – Member, Founding Committee, KFCRI**

Sri Nikila M. has graduated in law from the School of Excellence in Law, Tamil Nadu Dr. Ambedkar Law University, Chennai. With strong academic performance and a passion for international law, she aspires to pursue higher studies and eventually work with the United Nations. She has also been serving as an Assistant Professor in Saveetha School of Law, Chennai. Her areas of interest include Arbitration, Human Rights, Constitutional Law, and Private International Law, and she has presented and published articles on Evidence, Arbitration, and Cross-Border Legal Issues. Nikila's dedication to Alternative Dispute Resolution (ADR) is reflected in her active involvement with KFCRI, where she had contributed to promoting the institution and strengthening its presence in the ADR field. Known for her leadership skills, energy, and commitment, she combines academic excellence with practical engagement, aiming to make notable contributions to Arbitration and the legal spectrum as a whole.

6. **Mr. SHANMUGA DEV – Member, Founding Committee, KFCRI**

Shanmuga Dev is an advocate specializing in taxation, corporate and commercial law, financial services, and litigation, with a strong interest in alternative dispute resolution (ADR). He is a Principal Associate at Lakshmikumaran & Sridharan Attorneys and practices before the High Court of Bombay and the High Court of Madras. Actively engaged in the ADR community, he serves on the Managing Committee of KFCRI and is a member of Young ICCA and the Mumbai Centre for International Arbitration. His professional journey includes roles in project management and case handling with Kovise Foundation and the Southern India Chamber of Commerce and Industry. With dual qualifications in law and accountancy, Shanmuga combines expertise in taxation and litigation with a commitment to advancing ADR practice in India.

7. **Mr. SHARUKUMAR S I – Member, Founding Committee, KFCRI**



Sharukumar S.I. is a law graduate from the School of Excellence in Law, Tamil Nadu Dr. Ambedkar Law University, Chennai (Class of 2021). He is currently a Legal Associate at K. Elangovan Associates, where he practices across litigation and alternative dispute resolution (ADR). Earlier in his career, he served as a Tribunal Secretary in arbitration proceedings, gaining valuable exposure to dispute resolution processes. An accredited associate member of KFCRI and student member of several international arbitration institutions including CIArb, he has also worked as a Mediator and Dispute Resolution Advisor. Sharukumar has been the Vice-Chairperson and Treasurer of the NILS Tamil Nadu Chapter, connecting law students globally, and has authored articles and research papers on contemporary legal issues. His interests span Criminology, Taxation, Labour Disputes, Commercial Law, and Civil Litigation. Passionate about promoting ADR and legal awareness at the grassroots level, he is committed to advancing access to justice and dispute resolution in diverse communities.

CORE COMMITTEE

1. **Mr. ANANT MERATHIA**

Anant Merathia is a corporate lawyer with over 20 years of experience in India and Singapore, specializing in restructuring and insolvency, commercial litigation, ADR, and corporate governance. He began his career in Chennai in 2004, focusing on shareholder disputes and commercial law, before completing his LLM at the National University of Singapore and working with leading Singapore law firms as a Registered Foreign Lawyer. Since returning to India in 2009, he has advised clients on cross-border disputes, insolvency, restructuring, and corporate advisory matters, representing promoters, financial institutions, and resolution applicants before NCLTs and NCLAT. Anant is the Founder and Managing Partner of *Anant Merathia & Associates (AMA)*, a boutique firm recognized for its work in insolvency and ADR, and is a member of the ASEAN Plus Group. He is also the author of *Defaulter's Paradise Lost* and is finalizing a book on India's corporate insolvency laws. Recognized with the "Rising Star" Award by *Legal Era* and listed among India's top disputes lawyers by *Asian Legal Business*, Anant is a frequent speaker on corporate law, insolvency, and ADR at leading institutions and forums.

2. Mr. ARAVAMUDHAN ULAGANATHAN RAVINDRAN

Mr. Aravamudhan Ulaganathan Ravindran is a counsel, consultant, and coach with over a decade of experience in international arbitration, mediation, contracts, and international law. He has advised on strategy, change management, cross-cultural management, and policy, and has taught courses in international economic law, investment and commercial arbitration, EU law, and contract drafting at university level. Raghav has worked across Asia, Europe, and North America, representing clients in arbitration and litigation, mentoring entrepreneurs, and consulting on international political economy. Formerly a Partner at Kove Global LLP and Research Scholar at Riga Graduate School of Law, he has published widely on arbitration and international law. Currently based in Canada, he combines legal practice with leadership roles in social entrepreneurship and business management, bringing a global perspective shaped by professional and volunteer experience across five countries and multiple sectors.

3. **Mr. DEEPAK NARAYANAN**

Mr. Deepak Narayanan FCIArb is a Partner at BDN Chambers and a seasoned arbitration practitioner with over a decade of experience in litigation and dispute resolution. He regularly appears before the High Court of Madras and serves as panel counsel for institutions including the Bank of India, Life Insurance Corporation, and the Indian Nursing Council. Deepak is a Fellow of the Chartered Institute of Arbitrators (CIArb), where he also serves on the Core Committee of the Young Members Group, and has contributed to arbitration practice through consultancy roles with Kove Global LLP and teaching engagements as Visiting Faculty at the Adani Institute of Infrastructure Management. His international exposure includes internships with the Singapore International Arbitration Centre and Clyde & Co LLP. An alumnus of Queen Mary University of London (LLM, International Arbitration), Madras Law College, and Loyola College, Chennai, he has published widely on arbitration law and legislative reforms in India, combining academic insight with practical expertise in both domestic and international arbitration.

4. Ms. KIRTHI JAYAKUMAR

Ms. Kirthi Jayakumar is an activist, artist, entrepreneur, and writer from Chennai, India. She is the founder of the *Red Elephant Foundation*, a civilian peacebuilding initiative promoting gender equality through storytelling, advocacy, and digital interventions, and *fynePRINT*, a feminist e-publishing imprint. She is also a member of the UN Inter-Agency Network on Youth Development's Working Group for Gender Equality. Kirthi is the creator of *Saahas*, a web and mobile app supporting survivors of gender-based violence across 196 countries, and has spoken at global platforms including TEDx Chennai, FICCI FLO, and the UNV Partnerships Forum. Recognized internationally, she was invited to Michelle Obama's United State of Women Summit (2016) and President Obama's Town Hall in New Delhi (2017). Her honors include the US Presidential Services Medal, UN Online Volunteer of the Year Award (twice), the World Pulse Impact Leader Award, and the Digital Women Award for Social Impact. Beyond activism, Kirthi is an accomplished author and playwright, with works such as *The Doodler of Dimashq*, *The Dove's Lament*, and plays including *Frankly Speaking*, *HerStory*, and *Dolls*. Her art and writing continue to inspire global audiences in peacebuilding and gender equality.

5. **Mr. VENKATESAN RAMAKRISHNAN**

Venkatesan Ramakrishnan, FCIArb is an advocate and arbitrator with over 15 years of full-time practice in alternative dispute resolution. A Fellow of the Chartered Institute of Arbitrators (UK), he has presided over more than 1,000 institutional arbitrations and 50 ad hoc proceedings, publishing numerous awards across complex commercial, property, and investment disputes. His sector expertise spans BFSI, stock markets, IT, real estate, and construction. Venkatesan is empanelled with leading international institutions including CIArb (UK), DELOS (France), MIAC (Maldives), JAIAC (Jamaica), BVIIAC (BVI), and IIAC (India), as well as several domestic centres such as BIMACC, HAC, and Presolv360. He is also an accredited Independent Director and has served as legal consultant to corporate entities including Panasonic Appliances India. With a strong reputation for fairness and efficiency, he continues to contribute to the growth of arbitration practice in India and abroad.

6. Mr. MITESH RAVISHANKAR

Mitesh Ravishankar is an advocate based in Chennai with experience in intellectual property, litigation, and alternative dispute resolution (ADR). He is a Senior Partner at *MHV Partners* and has been actively involved with KFCRI, serving on its Core Committee. Mitesh is also the Co-Founder and Vice Chairman of *Vox Iura*, an initiative dedicated to advancing legal awareness and dispute resolution. His professional journey includes roles as Legal Associate with firms such as SV&R Partners, Raj and Raj Associates, and Nathan and Associates, where he gained exposure to diverse areas of practice. A graduate of Dr. Ambedkar Law University's School of Excellence in Law (B.Com LL.B.), Mitesh combines legal expertise with strong organizational and operational skills, contributing to both litigation and ADR practice.

7. **Ms. SWETHA C P**

Swetha C.P. is an Advocate and alumna of Tamil Nadu Dr. Ambedkar Law University, Chennai. Passionate about commercial arbitration and conciliation, she has actively written and presented articles on diverse topics, including safety and security for women in colleges. She has also shown interest in forensic science and envisions creating a platform in the future to advance this field. Swetha is deeply committed to the growth of alternative dispute resolution (ADR) in India and contributes to KFCRI's initiatives. She has led the *Project – Training and Empanelment of Tribunal Secretaries*, which aims to build a pool of professionally skilled tribunal secretaries for both ad hoc and institutional arbitration cases in India and globally. Known for her energy, determination, and leadership, she inspires her peers and is poised to become a role model for the next generation of women advocates.

8. **Mr. SARAN ULAGANATHAN**

Saran Ulaganathan is an Advocate from Devakottai and an alumnus of the School of Excellence in Law, Tamil Nadu Dr. Ambedkar Law University. He has maintained a strong academic record and has also contributed as a tutor at Tutelite Academy, where he was recognized with the *Tutor of the Year* award for several consecutive years. Saran has interned with institutions such as the Tamil Nadu State Human Rights Commission and various ADR centres, gaining practical exposure to dispute resolution. He, with KFCRI, has led *Project – Grass Root ADR* for KFCRI, an initiative aimed at empowering individuals at the grassroots level by creating awareness of ADR clauses and establishing ADR centres across panchayats in Tamil Nadu, with plans for global expansion. He has also been active in the National Service Scheme, providing legal advice to rural communities. Beyond law, his interests include Tamil literature and yoga, which have shaped his discipline and perspective. Known for his determination and leadership, Saran is committed to advancing ADR and serving as an inspiration for future generations of advocates.

SECRETARIAT

1. **Mrs. Surya Narmada Inbavijayan – Head, Secretariat, KFCRI**

Surya Narmada Inbavijayan is the Founder of Kovise Foundation Conflict Resolution International (KFCRI), a leading institution dedicated to promoting alternative dispute resolution (ADR) worldwide. She is also a horticulturist, agriculture arbitration consultant, and government-registered valuer for agricultural lands. Holding a postgraduate degree in horticulture from Tamil Nadu Agricultural University, she brings over two decades of expertise as a consultant, trainer, and advisor in agriculture and horticulture. Surya is the Proprietor of *Kovise Agro*, an agribusiness venture connecting farmers and producer companies directly with consumers, and the Founder and Managing Trustee of *Kovise Foundation*, which works to empower rural communities through knowledge and social development. In addition, she is a Partner at *Kove Global LLP*, an arbitration and ADR boutique specializing in agriculture and commodity disputes. Her professional strengths include farm planning, orchard management, landscape design, and therapeutic horticulture, complemented by extensive training programs delivered to NGOs, universities, and rural communities. A Fellow of the Institution of Valuers, she continues to drive innovation in agriculture, dispute resolution, and sustainable development.

2. **Mr. Pranav Inbavijayan – Coordinator, Internship & Research, KFCRI**

Pranav Inbavijayan is a civil engineering graduate and law student specializing in construction law and international arbitration. He is the Co-Founder and Intern Coordinator of *KFCRI ADR Institution* and a Charter Member of the *GSADR Alliance*. Pranav has gained hands-on experience through internships with leading legal practitioners and institutions, including the Chambers of Mr. V. Inbavijayan, BDN Chambers, and the High Court of Madras. He has also worked with Larsen & Toubro in their Contracts Division and coordinated projects at the Kovise Foundation. His academic background includes a Bachelor of Engineering from SRM University, ongoing LL.B. (Hons.) studies at Tamil Nadu Dr. Ambedkar Law University, and executive education in international commercial arbitration at King's College London. With certifications in construction law, investment arbitration, and dispute resolution, Pranav blends technical expertise with legal training and aspires to build a career in international arbitration practice.

3. Mr. S Sipivisht – Coordinator - Case Management & Administration, KFCRI

Sipi Visht S is an Advocate, Associate in Arbitration, and Empanelled Arbitrator with over Four years of focused experience in alternative dispute resolution (ADR). Based in Chennai, he is also a Charter Member of the *GSADR Alliance* and has trained under the mentorship of internationally renowned arbitrator Mr. V. Inbavijayan. His practice spans international arbitration, settlement negotiations, and contract risk management, with a strong emphasis on efficiency, neutrality, and resolution-oriented strategies. At *Kove Global LLP*, Sipi represents clients in institutional and ad hoc arbitrations, drafts pleadings and settlement agreements, and advises on dispute avoidance and enforcement of awards. He has also contributed to KFCRI in various roles, including Tribunal Secretary and Associate in Arbitrator Practice, and has delivered training sessions and workshops on ADR across India. His international exposure includes a legal internship at the *Hong Kong International Arbitration Centre (HKIAC)*, where he supported case research and procedural compliance. With certifications in UNCITRAL Mediation and International Commercial Arbitration, Sipi continues to build his expertise in ADR while mentoring interns and promoting a culture of dialogue and resolution among emerging legal professionals.

4. **Ms. SHAKTHI PRIYA K – Coordinator - Membership & Empanelment, KFCRI**

Shakthi Priya is an Advocate and Maritime Lawyer specializing in arbitration, mediation, and dispute resolution. She is currently pursuing her LL.M. in Maritime Law at the School of Excellence in Law, Tamil Nadu Dr. Ambedkar Law University. Alongside her academic work, she serves as Institutional Coordinator at the *Southern India Chamber of Commerce and Industry (SICCI) Centre for ADR* and as an Associate at *Kovise Foundation Conflict Resolution International (KFCRI)*. She also works as Tribunal Secretary to Mr. V. Inbavijayan, providing case management and procedural support in arbitration matters. Her professional experience spans drafting arbitral instruments, conducting legal research, and coordinating ADR proceedings, with particular focus on maritime and commercial disputes. Shakthi has delivered lectures, participated in outreach initiatives, and adjudicated Med-Arb competitions, contributing to the promotion of ADR among emerging legal professionals. With certifications in UNCITRAL Mediation and International Commercial Arbitration, as well as training in maritime law and cyber security, she combines academic rigor with practical expertise to advance efficient dispute resolution in specialized sectors.

5. Mr. DEVADATHAN V – Coordinator - Training & Capacity Building, KFCRI

Adv. Devadathan V is an Advocate and ADR Practitioner, currently serving as Associate Researcher at *Kovise Foundation Conflict Resolution International (KFCRI)*. A graduate of VIT University's School of Law with a B.A., LL.B. (Hons.), he has gained professional exposure through internships with KFCRI, the Office of the Advocate General of Kerala, and the High Court of Kerala, where he developed valuable insights into arbitration, litigation, and judicial processes. At KFCRI, he contributes to legal research, drafting, and the administration of arbitral tribunals, supporting efficient dispute resolution. Beyond academics and practice, Devadathan has presented research papers at international conferences and organized events such as the International Conference on Environmental Protection and Conservation. His leadership role as Convenor of the VITSOL Moot Court Society reflects his strong organizational and communication skills. With a solid foundation in law, practical exposure, and a commitment to continuous learning, he is poised to make meaningful contributions to the field of arbitration and dispute resolution.

6. **Mr. SILAMBARASAN M – Office Admin, KFCRI**

Silambarasan M serves as Office Administrator at *Kovise Foundation Conflict Resolution International (KFCRI)*. In this role, he supports the smooth functioning of the institution by overseeing administrative operations, coordinating internal processes, and assisting with organizational logistics. His responsibilities include managing documentation, facilitating communication across teams, and ensuring efficient day-to-day operations that enable KFCRI's projects and initiatives to run seamlessly. With a commitment to professionalism and organizational excellence, Silambarasan plays a key role in strengthening the institution's administrative backbone and supporting its mission to advance alternative dispute resolution.